Leave Policy 2026

Version 2.0 | Revised effective 1 July 2026 | Owner: Human Resources

1. Purpose

This policy explains the types of leave available to employees of Kalpa Systems, how leave is earned, how to apply for it, and what happens to unused leave at the end of the year. The goal is to give every employee adequate time to rest and attend to personal matters while ensuring that teams can plan their work.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all full-time employees on the company payroll in India, including employees on probation. Interns, consultants and contract staff are covered by the terms of their individual agreements and not by this policy.

3. Leave Entitlements

The leave year runs from 1 January to 31 December. Entitlements for employees who join mid-year are calculated on a pro-rata basis. The table below summarises the annual entitlements.

Leave type	Days per year	Carry forward	Encashable
Casual Leave	12	Up to 6 days	No
Sick Leave	10	Balance capped at 20 days	No
Earned Leave	18	Up to 30 days	Yes, at exit
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	Not applicable	No
Paternity Leave	5 working days	Not applicable	No
Bereavement Leave	3 working days	Not applicable	No

3.1 Casual Leave

Casual leave accrues at one day per month. It is meant for short, unplanned personal needs and may not be taken for more than three consecutive working days. Up to 6 unused casual leave days can be carried forward into the next leave year; any balance above that lapses on 31 December. Casual leave cannot be combined with earned leave in the same absence.

3.2 Sick Leave

Employees receive ten days of sick leave per year. A medical certificate from a registered practitioner is required for sick leave of more than two consecutive working days. Unused sick leave carries forward, but the total sick leave balance can never exceed twenty days.

3.3 Earned Leave

Earned leave accrues at 1.5 days per month after the employee is confirmed. Earned leave of three or more days must be applied for at least seven calendar days in advance. Up to thirty days can be carried forward. At the time of exit, the unused earned leave balance is encashed at the rate of the employee's basic salary.

3.4 Parental Leave

Female employees are entitled to 26 weeks of paid maternity leave for the first two children, in line with the Maternity Benefit Act. Male employees are entitled to five working days of paid paternity leave, to be taken within three months of the birth or adoption of a child.

4. Leave During Probation

During the six-month probation period employees may use casual leave and sick leave only. Earned leave accrues from the date of confirmation and cannot be used while on probation.

5. Applying for Leave

All leave must be applied for in the HRMS portal and approved by the reporting manager before it is taken. In an emergency, the employee must inform their manager on the same day by phone or chat and apply in the portal within two working days of returning.

6. Leave Without Pay

Once all applicable leave balances are exhausted, an employee may request leave without pay for up to thirty days in a leave year. Leave without pay requires approval from both the reporting manager and the HR business partner.

7. Public Holidays

The company observes ten declared public holidays and allows two restricted holidays of the employee's choice each year. The holiday calendar for the following year is published on the intranet every December.

8. Contact

Questions about this policy can be sent to the HR helpdesk at hr-helpdesk@kalpa.example.